# Jon Toews

CONTACT:

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PRACTICE

Creative director · Creative technologist

RECOGNITION

Cannes Lions (incl. Design) · Clio Awards · New York Festivals · Communication Arts · Creative Floor

CURRENT

Creative Director
Sessional Instructor, OCAD University

## PROFILE

**Creative director in advertising, design and digital, leading teams of up to 120 at Klick Health, Critical Mass, Public Inc. and Bensimon Byrne. I build brand, digital and experiential work for regulated and complex categories (healthcare and pharma, financial services, B2B technology). Work recognized at Cannes Lions, the Clios, New York Festivals and Communication Arts.**

## EXPERIENCE

2025 – PRESENT

### Intercept

CREATIVE DIRECTOR · TORONTO

- Lead creative for global enterprise technology brands at a Toronto B2B agency.
- Concepted interactive, mobile-first activations that bring Lenovo's workstation and Intel-powered AI PC story to FIFA watch-party events and Lenovo.com.
- Develop AI-forward and programmatic concepts, including interactive territories for the agency's own holiday campaign.

2018 – 2027

### OCAD University

SESSIONAL INSTRUCTOR, FACULTY OF DESIGN · TORONTO

- Teach Advanced Copywriting (ADVR-3010) in the Advertising program.

2019 – 2023

### Klick Health / Katalyst

EXECUTIVE CREATIVE DIRECTOR · TORONTO

- Led and mentored a 50-person creative team, including four creative directors, on a $60M business.
- Built Axsome Therapeutics' corporate brand and communications system, the Auvelity launch platform for major depressive disorder, and won five future-indication assignments.
- Led MDD disease-awareness work recognized by New York Festivals, Communication Arts and Creative Floor.
- Repositioned and redesigned Klick's own brand and Klick.com to attract talent; wrote, directed and scored the Klick holiday film (Clio, Creative Floor).

2017 – 2019

### Public Inc.

EXECUTIVE CREATIVE DIRECTOR · TORONTO

- Led strategists, designers, writers and content creators on purpose-driven work for Converse, Scotiabank, Universal, Danone, the City of Toronto, Meals on Wheels, Girl Scouts of the USA and Fresh City Farms.
- Won and executed Converse's social-responsibility platform for its recycled shoe line.

2013 – 2016

### Critical Mass

EXECUTIVE CREATIVE DIRECTOR / GENERAL MANAGER · TORONTO

- Ran the 120-person Toronto office, with oversight of creative, client service, project management and technology on $50M of brands.

- As global executive creative director on Citi, led Future of Banking discovery and prototypes on five- and ten-year horizons, piloted in markets worldwide, and reframed Citi's marketing platform as "Citi OS."
- Helped win NASA's ground-up web redesign with speculative concepts and working prototypes, then led delivery across technology, UX, content and design.
- Sweeper for UNMAS (Cannes Lions, New York Festivals, Communication Arts) and the Massey Lectures app for House of Anansi (Cannes Lion, Design).

2008 – 2012

### Bensimon Byrne / Mighty

CREATIVE DIRECTOR / MANAGING DIRECTOR · TORONTO

- Led the agency's digital practice: 30 people across technology, creative, planning and client service. Member of the senior management team.
- Created Scotiabank's "Let the Saving Begin" platform under "You're Richer Than You Think."

## CAPABILITIES

**LEADERSHIP**

Creative team leadership and mentoring · Pitching and new business · Client partnership · Multi-discipline studio management

**CRAFT**

Integrated campaigns · Brand identity and design systems · Digital product and UX · Experiential and interactive · Film and animation direction · Copywriting · Music and sound

**AI & TECHNOLOGY**

Generative AI for concepting and production (image, video, LLM) · AI-agent prototyping · Creative workflow automation · Web prototyping (HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Web Audio) · Figma · Adobe Creative Cloud

**SECTORS**

Healthcare and pharma · Financial services · B2B and enterprise technology · Public sector and non-profit · Consumer brands

## CREATIVE PRACTICE

- jontoews.com/projects — experiments in emergence: simple rules and small systems that grow into instruments, worlds and language.
- Graphic design — typography.
- Published short-fiction writer; composer and music director.